UNIT 1 · TOPIC 7(C)

Cotton Equipment

Syllabus topic: Special equipment for crops: vegetables, sugarcane, cotton, groundnut, potato and fruit crops

Planting

- **Cotton planter:** pneumatic or inclined-plate; delinted seed is preferred.

Harvesting

Machine	How it works
Spindle picker (selective)	Tapered, barbed rotating spindles wind seed cotton from open bolls; moistened pads are used; a doffer removes the cotton from the spindles. Allows multiple pickings.
Stripper (non-selective)	Fingers/brushes strip the entire plant — open and unopened bolls — in one once-over harvest. Suits compact/storm-proof varieties.

- Inter-culture: use selective flaming once cotton stems have hardened (Topic 4b).
- Cotton picking remains one of the least mechanized operations in India (Topic 1a).

Practice MCQs

Q58. The cotton spindle picker harvests:

(a) Whole plants
(b) Only seed cotton from open bolls (selective)
(c) Open + unopened bolls
(d) Lint only

Answers

Q58 — (b) Only seed cotton from open bolls (selective)